

Task 6: GoPhish Simulated Phishing Campaign Report

Prepared for: MuLearn Bootcamp

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Date: October 26, 2025 Platform: Local Lab Environment (Self-hosted GoPhish in VM)

Task Type: Ethical Hacking, Social Engineering

Introduction

GoPhish is a powerful, open-source phishing framework used by security professionals to conduct phishing campaigns and security awareness training. It allows organizations to test their workforce for vulnerabilities by simulating real-world phishing attacks, tracking employee responses, and analyzing the results. This report documents a simulated phishing campaign run in a controlled VM environment for educational purposes.

Objective

The objective of this task was to conduct a controlled phishing simulation using the GoPhish framework. The goal was to understand the mechanics of a social engineering attack from an attacker's perspective to better build defenses. This practical exercise helps in evaluating security awareness and testing the "human firewall" within an organization.

Tool Used

- **GoPhish:** A legitimate, open-source phishing framework designed for security professionals to run ethical phishing campaigns. It provides a web interface to create email templates, build fake landing pages, and track real-time campaign results.

Tasks Completed

Task 1: Environment Setup

- Set up and configured the GoPhish open-source framework in a local lab environment on a Kali Linux VM.

Task 2: Creating the Lure

- **Landing Page Creation:** A replica landing page was created to mimic the official Google login page. Copied the source code from `/usr/share/set/src/html/templates/google/index.template` and set the redirect URL to `https://accounts.google.com` for legitimacy after login.
- **Email Template Design:** A convincing email template was designed using a real 2-step verification email as bait, encouraging the target to click a link leading to the fake landing page.

Task 3: Defining Targets and Delivery

- **User & Group Management:** A list of target users was created and organized into a group for the campaign.
- **Sending Profile Configuration:** A sending profile was set up with SMTP details and verified by sending a test email.

Task 4: Campaign Execution and Monitoring

- **Campaign Launch:** A campaign titled "Google Security Alert" was launched, sending the phishing email to the designated target group.
- **Result Analysis:** Monitored the GoPhish dashboard to track the campaign's progress. The results confirmed that both emails were opened, and the link to the landing page was clicked by both targets.

Outcome

The phishing simulation was successfully executed, and the desired outcome was achieved. The GoPhish dashboard results confirmed that the targets engaged with the email, opened it, and clicked the link. This highlights the effectiveness of social engineering and the need for user training. No real harm was done, as this was run in an isolated VM with test emails.

Conclusion

This exercise demonstrated how easily phishing attacks can succeed due to human factors. GoPhish proved to be an excellent tool for ethical simulations. Key takeaways include the importance of realistic email design, landing page validation, and real-time monitoring. Organizations should use such tools regularly to strengthen security awareness.



Sending

New Profile

No profiles created yet. Let's create one

New Sending Profile

Name:

Profile name

Interface Type:

SMTP

SMTP From: ⓘ

First Last <test@example.com>

Host:

smtp.example.com:25

Username:

Username

Password:

Password

☒ Ignore Certificate Errors ⓘ

Email Headers:

X-Custom-Header

[[URL]] goshish

+ Add Custom Header

Show

10

 entries

Search:

Header ⓘ	Value ⓘ
No data available in table	

Send Test Email

Email Sent!

Send Test Email to:

ferronic

ferro

ferronic.ferro@gmail.com

Position

Cancel

Send

.....

☒ Ignore Certificate Errors

Email Headers:

X-Custom-Header

{{URL}}-gophish

+ Add Custom Header

Show

10

 entries

Search:

Header	Value
No data available in table	

Showing 0 to 0 of 0 entries

Send Test Email

Previous

Next

Cancel

Save Profile

[illegible]

The screenshot shows the Gophish web interface with the 'New Campaign' modal open. The form contains the following fields and options:

- Name:** ferronic campaign
- Email Template:** Google
- Landing Page:** Google Login
- URL:** http://192.168.29.138
- Launch Date:** September 28th 2025, 7:45 pm
- Send Emails By (Optional):** (empty)
- Sending Profile:** ferronic
- Groups:** shadow

Buttons at the bottom: 'Close' and 'Launch Campaign'.



